



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	13 November 2023	Time of Incident:	11:30
Region / Directorate:	Goldfields Esperance	Main Roads or Contractor:	Employee
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Incident - Injury	EQSafe Incident Number:	35216
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	MOP collided with Main Roads Employee after veering into oncoming lane
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Executive Summary:

On 13th November 2023, a Works Supervisor (IP) was travelling eastbound between pavement repair sections on the Highway, trailing a Contractor's water truck. While undertaking the drive, a member of public (MOP) travelling in the opposite direction (westbound) drifted across the lane into the oncoming traffic lane and struck the front driver's side of the IP's light vehicle. The IP undertook controlled braking within the eastbound lane and came to a stop, whilst the MOP's vehicle swerved back to the westbound lane and came to rest in the table drain.

The light vehicle sustained unrepairable damaged to the driver's side front panels and tyres.

IP and MOP were transported to the hospital. The MOP had experienced a medical episode whilst driving, which resulted in the incident occurring.

Incident Photos:



Position of Main Roads' vehicle after incident



Position of MOP's vehicle after incident

Contributing Factors:

- Members of Public do not always adhere to the traffic control signage in place, thereby, placing themselves and those who are undertaking works at risk. The MOP was driving at 80km/hr through the work area. Traffic control signage indicated speed restriction of 60km/hr was in place at the time of the incident.
- Members of Public are unknown factors when working on project sites and travelling on the network.

Corrective Actions:

- Ongoing vigilance while driving is imperative; situational awareness increases the likelihood of early recognition of the hazard and thus reduce the risk and potential severity.
- Ensure risk assessments have been conducted to assess each working environment.
- Practice active communication amongst team to warn of errant drivers.
- Review training register to confirm currency of Defensive Driver training, in line with the organisation's vehicle policy or guideline.

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- All workers should be aware of the importance that only those who are required for incident management are to enter the incident scene after an incident. Incident scenes can place workers at risk and excess personnel does not allow for privacy of those involved.
- Trauma response (Employee Assistance Program) is available to provide proactive support to employees exposed to traumatic events.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Vehicle Incident.

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations